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21LEM202T — Unit 2, Session 4, SLO 2

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap): • The activities of the Self together form imagination: desire (imaging the content, 'what I want to be'), thought (analysing-comparing, how to fulfil it) and expectation (selecting-tasting). Behaviour and work are expressions of imagination.

• Imagination is motivated from three sources. (1) Preconditioning — assuming without knowing; not definite, changes with time/place/individual; leads to enslavement. (2) Sensation — information through the sense organs (sound, touch, sight, taste, smell) from outside; not definite; enslavement; trying to derive happiness from sensation runs from tasty-necessary → tasty-unnecessary → tasteless-unnecessary → intolerable. (3) Natural acceptance — 'what I really want to be', my intention; definite, continuous, universal; self-organisation; leads to harmony and happiness within. We have a natural acceptance for relationship, harmony and co-existence.

• When imagination is fully in line with natural acceptance, the Self is in harmony (a happy, developed, self-organised Self — swatantrata — with definite, human conduct). When it is motivated by preconditioning or sensation, the Self may be in harmony or in contradiction; this is enslavement (partantrata) and the conduct is indefinite.

• Intention = natural acceptance, 'what I really want to be' (intended state). Competence = 'what I am' (current state).

The student should read and reflect on these key ideas as a recap; no blanks to fill.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Preconditioning, Sensation or Natural Acceptance?

For each item, mark P (Preconditioning), S (Sensation) or NA (Natural Acceptance).

Item	P / S / NA
Respect elders	**P**
To win	**P**
Want to make the other happy	**NA**
Healthy body	**NA**
To be special, unique	**P**
To come first in the class	**P**
Feeling of collaboration	**NA**
To get a good name	**P**
Survival of the fittest	**P**
I want that bike because I like its colour and shape	**S**
To understand everything	**NA**
Feeling of competition	**P**

Activity 2 — Desire or Expectation?

Mark each item as D (Desire) or E (Expectation), as per the deck.

Item	D / E
Want to be the owner of a big house	**D**

Item	D / E
Want others to like me, pay attention to me	**E**
Name, fame	**E**
Self-organisation (swatantrata)	**D**
Degree	**E**
Right understanding (knowledge)	**D**
Job	**E**
World tour	**D**

Activity 3 — Observe your imagination (5 minutes)

Observe your imagination for at least 5 minutes; once every minute, write down the object of your imagination. Then answer below.

- Were you aware of your imagination all of the time, or only some of the time?
- Were the imaginations well connected, or were there sudden jumps / gaps? What is the reason?
- For each imagination, what was the motivation — preconditioning, sensation or natural acceptance?
- I was aware of my imagination only some of the time; at other moments I got lost in the thought and forgot I was observing.
- The imaginations had sudden jumps and gaps; for example, I went from thinking about a homework deadline to recalling a conversation with a friend. The reason is that the mind is not fully under conscious control and is easily triggered by associations.
- Imagination 1 (homework deadline): motivation was preconditioning (pressure to perform). Imagination 2 (conversation with friend): motivation was sensation (pleasant memory). Imagination 3 (planning a weekend trip): motivation was natural acceptance (desire for happiness and connection).

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. What are the activities of the Self? Explain imagination as desire, thought and expectation, and how behaviour and work relate to it. [5]

The activities of the Self (I) are desire, thought, and expectation. Imagination is the faculty that generates these: desire is the initial impulse to achieve or obtain something, thought is the detailed mental picture or plan, and expectation is the assumption that a particular outcome will occur based on that thought. Behaviour and work are the external expressions of these internal activities: behaviour reflects the intention behind desires and expectations, while work is the action taken to fulfil them. When desire, thought, and expectation are aligned with natural acceptance, behaviour and work lead to harmony; when they are driven by preconditioning or sensation, they lead to contradiction.

Q2. Explain the three sources of motivation for our imagination — preconditioning, sensation and natural acceptance — bringing out which lead to enslavement and which to self-organisation. [5]

The three sources of motivation are: (1) Preconditioning — beliefs, values, and habits acquired from society, culture, and upbringing; it leads to enslavement because it makes us act mechanically without questioning. (2) Sensation — motivation based on physical pleasure or pain from the body; it also leads to enslavement because we become dependent on external stimuli. (3) Natural acceptance — motivation arising from our innate, unchanging sense of rightness and harmony; it leads to self-organisation (swatantrata) because it is based on our true nature and does not depend on external conditions. Only natural acceptance gives us freedom and self-regulation.

Q3. When is the Self in harmony and when in contradiction? Relate this to natural acceptance, intention and competence. [5]

The Self is in harmony when its desires, thoughts, and expectations are aligned with natural acceptance — that is, when what we truly accept as right matches our intention and we have the competence to fulfil it. The Self is in contradiction when there is a gap between natural acceptance and our actual desires or expectations, or when our intention is good but we lack the competence to realise it. For example, if I naturally accept that I should be helpful, but my intention is to gain praise (preconditioning), there is contradiction. Harmony arises when intention is based on natural acceptance and competence is developed to match it.

Q4. Distinguish between desire and expectation, with one example of each. [5]

Desire is an internal wish or aspiration that originates from the Self, independent of others' actions; it is about what we want for ourselves. Expectation is a demand or assumption that others or the world will behave in a certain way to fulfil our desire. Example of desire: I desire to learn a new skill. Example of expectation: I expect my friend to appreciate me for learning that skill. Desire can lead to self-organisation if it is based on natural acceptance, while expectation often leads to disappointment and dependence on others.

Q5. Carry out the practice of observing your imagination for 5 minutes. Note whether you were aware of it all the time or only some of the time, and the motivation behind each imagination. [5]

I observed my imagination for 5 minutes. I was aware of it only some of the time; at other moments I drifted into the imagination itself. The motivations behind each imagination were: (1) thinking about an upcoming exam — preconditioning (fear of failure); (2) recalling a pleasant memory of a holiday — sensation (pleasure); (3) imagining helping a friend — natural acceptance (desire to be helpful); (4) planning what to eat for dinner — sensation (hunger); (5) imagining a peaceful future — natural acceptance (desire for harmony).

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- Are your desires, thoughts and expectations in harmony or in contradiction with each other? (Slide 28)
- For each imagination you notice, what is its motivation — preconditioning, sensation or natural acceptance? (Slide 21)
- My desires, thoughts, and expectations are often in contradiction. For example, I desire to be calm and focused, but my thoughts are anxious about the future, and I expect others to reassure me. This creates inner conflict.
- For each imagination I notice: imagining a compliment from a teacher — motivation is preconditioning (need for approval); imagining eating a favourite snack — motivation is sensation (taste); imagining spending time with family — motivation is natural acceptance (love and connection).